SPIRITUAL/RELIGIOUS FALSE BELIEF #68 · HELL

“I’m going to hell because of my many sins.”

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Where it often comes from

A long history of sin, addiction, or broken relationships. Shame that has grown over many years. Being told you were bad or hopeless as a child. Frightening teaching about hell without the good news of grace. Depression, which can make hopeless thoughts feel like facts.

What Scripture teaches

Sin is real, and its wages is death. But that is not the end of the sentence: the gift of God is eternal life in Christ Jesus. God proved His love by sending Christ to die for us while we were still sinners. Christ came into the world to save sinners, even the worst. Where sin increased, grace increased all the more. A thief dying on a cross asked Jesus to remember him, and Jesus promised him Paradise that very day. The number of your sins is not what decides your eternity; your answer to Jesus is.

> *“For the wages of sin is death, but the gift of God is eternal life in Christ Jesus our Lord”* **(Romans 6:23)**.

Also see

> “But God proves His love for us in this: While we were still sinners, Christ died for us. Therefore, since we have now been justified by His blood, how much more shall we be saved from wrath through Him!” **(Romans 5:8–9)**.

> “This is a trustworthy saying, worthy of full acceptance: Christ Jesus came into the world to save sinners, of whom I am the worst” **(1 Timothy 1:15)**.

> “For God so loved the world that He gave His one and only Son, that everyone who believes in Him shall not perish but have eternal life. For God did not send His Son into the world to condemn the world, but to save the world through Him” **(John 3:16–17)**.

> “Then he said, ‘Jesus, remember me when You come into Your kingdom!’ And Jesus said to him, ‘Truly I tell you, today you will be with Me in Paradise.’” **(Luke 23:42–43)**.

Common self-statements

- I’ve done too much; hell is where I belong.
- My sins are too many to count.
- God could never take someone like me.
- It’s too late for me.
- I deserve hell, so that’s where I’m going.
- Grace is for better people.

Common logical errors

- **Magnification:** Making the number of your sins larger than the grace of God.
- **Fortune telling:** Predicting your eternal future while ignoring God’s offer.
- **Emotional reasoning:** Concluding “I feel hopeless, so I must be lost.”

- **Labeling:** Seeing yourself as “hell-bound” instead of “a sinner Jesus came to save.”

Challenging questions

- What is the second half of Romans 6:23?
- When did Christ die for us: after we cleaned up, or while we were still sinners?
- Paul called himself the worst of sinners. What did God do with him?
- What did Jesus say to the thief on the cross?
- Is my eternity decided by my sin count or by my response to Jesus?
- Could depression or shame be speaking louder than God’s Word?
- Have I ever asked Jesus to save me? Could I do it now?

Truth summary

> I am not going to hell because of my many sins. Jesus died for sinners like me, and God offers me the free gift of eternal life in Christ. Where my sin increased, His grace increased all the more. When I trust Jesus, I am justified by His blood and saved from wrath through Him. My many sins are not greater than His grace.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Hell
- Salvation
- Grace
- Forgiveness
- Hopeless

Listen: Overcoming Depression

> **Overcoming Depression** · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 20 minutes

Each morning ask: “If I truly believed God’s truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?”

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HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "I'm going to hell because of my many sins"

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Read through each section and **check the one that fits you best**. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ **Date started:** _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"I'm going to hell because of my many sins." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ What is the second half of Romans 6:23?
- ☐ When did Christ die for us?
- ☐ What did God do with Paul, the worst sinner?
- ☐ What did Jesus promise the thief?
- ☐ Is eternity decided by my sins or my response to Jesus?
- ☐ Could I ask Jesus to save me now?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ The gift of God is eternal life in Christ Jesus.
- ☐ Christ died for me while I was still a sinner.
- ☐ Jesus came to save sinners like me.
- ☐ My many sins are not greater than His grace.
- ☐ If I trust Jesus, I am saved from wrath through Him.
- ☐ It is not too late to come to Jesus.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- [ ] **Romans 6:23**
  "For the wages of sin is death, but the gift of God is eternal life in Christ Jesus our Lord."
- [ ] **Romans 5:8–9**
  "But God proves His love for us in this: While we were still sinners, Christ died for us. Therefore, since we have now been justified by His blood, how much more shall we be saved from wrath through Him!"
- [ ] **1 Timothy 1:15**
  "This is a trustworthy saying, worthy of full acceptance: Christ Jesus came into the world to save sinners, of whom I am the worst."
- [ ] **John 3:16–17**
  "For God so loved the world that He gave His one and only Son, that everyone who believes in Him shall not perish but have eternal life. For God did not send His Son into the world to condemn the world, but to save the world through Him."
- [ ] **Luke 23:42–43**
  "Then he said, 'Jesus, remember me when You come into Your kingdom!' And Jesus said to him, 'Truly I tell you, today you will be with Me in Paradise.'"

A verse I found myself: _____

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HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

Practicing the Truth

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5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first three. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- ☐ **Make my Truth Card** (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- ☐ **Memorize my Scripture** from Step 4.
- ☐ **Set reminders** to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ **A buzz:** my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ **An everyday event:** every time I _____
  - ☐ **A visual reminder:** something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- ☐ **Hope journal:** Each day, write one promise of God's grace for sinners and one way I responded to Jesus.
- ☐ **My name in Scripture:** Rewrite my verse with my name in it and read it aloud each morning.
  *For example, Romans 5:8 becomes: "But God proves His love for **Sarah** in this: While **she** was still a sinner, Christ died for **her**."*
- ☐ **Gratitude journal:** Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- ☐ **Truth recording:** Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- ☐ **Reading:** The "Salvation" topic in Pearls.
- ☐ **Listening:** The Overcoming Depression audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

- ☐ **Pray the thief's prayer in your own words:** "Jesus, remember me," and ask Him to save you, or thank Him that He has.
- ☐ **Read Luke 23:32–43,** and write what the thief did and what Jesus promised him.
- ☐ **Write Romans 6:23 on a card,** underline the second half, and carry it with you.
- ☐ **Talk with a pastor or Christian counselor this week.** If you ever feel hopeless or think about harming yourself, call or text 988 (in the U.S.) right away.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

What I learned: _____

The lie "I'm going to hell because of my many sins": _____ % **My truth:** _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	One promise of grace I read
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~I'm going to hell because of my many sins.~~

THE TRUTH

_____

_____

GOD'S WORD

_____

_____

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Lord Jesus, I have sinned many times, but You came to save sinners like me. Help me reject the lie that I am going to hell because of my many sins. Remember me, save me, and help me receive the gift of eternal life. Thank You that Your grace is greater than all my sin. In Your name, Amen.

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